THE SNOWDEN EFFECT

In June 2013, members of the Obama administration and other US political leaders were focused on capturing Snowden and bringing him to justice. At the same time, a groundswell of anger was emerging against secret surveillance activities, including demands for change. In what would become known as the Snowden Effect, changes that resulted from the NSA documents Snowden leaked would be felt in Congress, the courts, world capitals, and business boardrooms.

Presidential Panel

In August 2013, President Obama created a panel to respond to the documents Snowden leaked. Four months later, on December 18, the panel released a 308-page report. The panelists concluded that mass-collected NSA phone metadata had not been proven to be essential to prevent terrorist attacks. Among the report's

A panel of government officials sits at a Senate Intelligence Committee hearing in 2013.

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